LEGAL SUCCESS INDIA

GST INVOICING APPLICATION

Deep Product Requirements Document (PRD), Screen Specification & Developer Blueprint

Reference product: Zoho Invoice public feature catalogue and demo conventions

Build objective: Original, company-owned, self-hosted invoicing system

Focus: Professional GST invoices, client records, quotations, payments, PDF documents, reporting, roles and auditability

Prepared for: Legal Success India

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HOW TO USE THIS DOCUMENT

- Give this document to the developer before requesting a quote. Ask them to respond against the feature IDs, acceptance tests, exclusions and handover requirements.
- Treat P0 as launch-critical. P1 is useful but can follow the first safe release. P2 needs separate budget and should not delay core invoicing.
- Company identity, GST treatment, tax classification, invoice series and legal document rules are placeholders until confirmed by the owner and CA.

Important: this is a product/engineering specification, not legal or tax advice. Current GST rules and applicability must be checked with the company's CA and official portals before issuing live invoices.

1. Product vision and scope

Build a focused invoicing application that gives Legal Success India control over invoice creation, branding, customer history and collections, without recreating an entire accounting ERP.

- **Working product name:** Legal Success Billing.
- **Primary goal:** Create accurate, branded GST/service invoices in minutes, maintain invoice history, record payments and export clean records for the accountant.
- **Target team:** Owner/admin plus billing staff, sales/service staff and accountant/reviewer; 5–25 employees overall.
- **Product posture:** Desktop-first responsive web app; usable on tablet/mobile for lookups and payment recording.
- **Ownership principle:** Source code, Git repository, domain, hosting, database and backups must be controlled by the company, not only by the developer.
- **No paid SaaS dependency:** Avoid a third-party invoicing subscription. Hosting, domain, email delivery, optional API providers and maintenance can still cost money.

Non-goals for MVP

- No full double-entry accounting, payroll, inventory warehouse, purchase-order procurement, bank-feed reconciliation or statutory return filing in the first release.
- No pretending a PDF is a government-issued invoice or an IRN has been generated when no authorised integration has actually generated it.
- No copying Zoho source code, logos, proprietary assets or pixel-perfect screens. Use the reference for feature expectations, but create original branding and implementation.

Core success measures

Metric	Initial target / measurement
Time to create a standard invoice	Under 3 minutes after customer and service are saved; validate with staff usability test.
Invoice calculation accuracy	100% pass rate on CA-approved tax and rounding test cases before production.
Invoice number collisions	Zero duplicate issued numbers, including concurrent users and retries.
Historical record integrity	Issued invoice/PDF does not change when customer, service or template settings change.
Payment visibility	Every issued invoice shows paid amount, balance, due date and status consistently.
Recovery	Documented backup restore tested before go-live; agreed RPO/RTO documented.

2. Reference-product analysis: what to learn from Zoho Invoice

Zoho's public feature catalogue describes invoices, quotes, contacts, payments, expenses, projects/timesheets, templates, automation, customer portal, reports, users/roles and item catalogue. The MVP below prioritises only what a service business needs first. Public source: Zoho Invoice features.

Reference feature family	Legal Success India decision	Reason
Dashboard	P0	Owner needs billed, collected, outstanding and overdue at a glance.
Invoices + templates	P0	Core deliverable; high quality PDF and reliable GST fields are non-negotiable.
Contacts/customers	P0	Repeat customers should not need to re-enter details.
Items/services	P0	Reusable service rates and tax defaults reduce mistakes.
Offline/manual payments	P0	Record UPI, bank transfer, cash and partial payments without gateway costs.
Estimates/quotes	P1	Useful for service proposals; can be added soon after invoicing core.
Credit notes/corrections	P0 safety design; final workflow CA-approved	Issued invoices must not be silently edited/deleted.
Expenses	P1 basic only	Helpful, but not a full accounting ledger.
Automated reminders	P1	Start with manual reminders; automate only after delivery reliability is tested.
Recurring invoices	P2	Only if the company has genuinely recurring client billing.
Client portal	P2	Adds auth, privacy, support and QA complexity; not needed to print invoices.
Gateway / WhatsApp API / GSTN integrations	P2	Requires third-party accounts, costs, approvals or compliance testing.
Projects/timesheets	P2 / omit unless required	Legal service billing is generally service/package-based; avoid complexity without a proven need.
Advanced analytics	P2	Basic invoice and receivable reports are enough for first release.

3. Users, roles and permission matrix

Use separate accounts per person. Do not share the owner login across the team. Every action must be checked by the backend/API, not only hidden from the interface.

Role	Allowed actions	Restrictions / approval
Owner / Super Admin	All modules, company/tax settings, users, export, backup status, audit log.	Critical setting changes logged; optional MFA.
Billing Manager	Create/edit drafts, issue/send invoices, record payments, credit-note request, reports.	Cannot delete audit history or take over owner account.
Billing Executive	Create customers, service lines, drafts, previews, send issued PDFs if permitted.	May require approval before issue; no tax/series setting access.
Sales / Case Coordinator	Customer records, quotes, internal service/case reference, view assigned customers.	No payment edits, no global financial reports unless granted.
Accountant / CA	Read invoices, payment history, credits, tax reports and export.	Read-only by default; corrections require approval.
Management Viewer	Dashboard and selected reports.	No create/edit/issue/payment actions.

Permissions should be granular: view, create, edit draft, submit for approval, approve, issue, send, record payment, reverse payment, create credit note, export, manage users, change company settings and view audit logs. Optional customer-level access restrictions can be added if teams must only see assigned clients.

4. App shell and navigation

Area	Screens	Common UI controls / behaviour
Global top bar	Company switch/profile (single company initially), global search, notifications, help, user menu.	Search invoice number/customer/service; user menu includes profile, sign out; notifications link to the relevant record.
Left sidebar	Dashboard, Invoices, Customers, Services/Items, Payments, Estimates, Credit Notes, Reports, Settings, Audit Log.	Active item highlight; collapse on small screens; hide modules by permission, but enforce API permissions regardless.
Global actions	New Invoice, New Customer, Record Payment, Export.	Use permission checks; disabled buttons explain missing access.
List pages	Search, filters, sort, pagination, column chooser where useful, export.	Keep filters when user opens a record and returns; show empty-state guidance.
Record detail	Summary header, status, action menu, tabs for details/activity/attachments/payments.	Dangerous actions require confirmation; never use ambiguous “Delete” for issued records.

UX rules

- Use consistent status labels and icons: Draft, Awaiting Approval, Issued, Sent, Partially Paid, Paid, Overdue, Cancelled/Void, Credited.
- Use clear primary actions: New Invoice, Save Draft, Preview, Submit for Approval, Issue Invoice, Send Invoice, Record Payment.
- For any destructive/corrective action, show what will happen, which record is affected, and whether the action can be reversed.
- Every table should support loading, empty, error and permission-denied states—not just the success view.
- Keyboard-friendly form flow; auto-focus the first field; inline validation; never clear valid user-entered data after a server error.

5. Dashboard specification

Widget	Calculation / action	Edge cases
Invoiced this period	Sum of issued invoice totals by invoice date; exclude drafts; define treatment of cancellations/credits.	Label date basis and whether totals include tax.
Collected this period	Sum of successful payment records by payment date, regardless of invoice date.	Do not count failed/voided payment records.
Outstanding receivables	Sum of balances for issued invoices, net of allocated payments and valid credits.	Avoid double counting unapplied payments.
Overdue	Outstanding balance where due date is before current date.	Paid/cancelled/voided records excluded.
Draft invoices	Count of drafts, optionally split awaiting approval.	Click opens filtered list.
Recent invoices	Latest issue date, number, customer, total, paid, balance, status.	Pagination or View All; protect customer data by role.
Monthly trend	Billed vs collected, clearly labelled by invoice-date/payment-date basis.	No misleading comparison if periods are incomplete.
Tax summary	Taxable amount and tax by configured component/rate for selected period.	Management report only; not guaranteed statutory filing output.
Overdue list	Customer, invoice, due date, overdue days, balance and reminder action.	Reminder suppressed if paid/voided.
System alerts	Email failures, backup stale, missing GST profile, numbering not configured.	Visible only to authorised users.

Filters: current month default; today, last 7/30/90 days, current FY, previous FY, custom date range; invoice status; customer; creator; service. All cards/charts/lists must use the same filter state or clearly display independent filters. Amounts use Indian digit grouping and INR currency.

6. Invoice register/list screen — field-level behaviour

Element	Specification	Acceptance / error handling
Search box	Search invoice number, customer legal/display name, GSTIN where permitted, client reference.	Debounce search; clear action resets search; server-side pagination.
Status filter	Draft, approval pending, issued/sent, partial, paid, overdue, cancelled/credited.	Overdue is a derived condition; don't make it mutually exclusive with payment history incorrectly.
Date filters	Invoice date range; separate created date filter only if needed.	Display timezone and date basis.
Amount columns	Invoice total, paid, balance.	Use stored snapshots and allocated payments; same results as detail page.
Actions	Open, edit draft, preview, download PDF, send/resend, record payment, duplicate to draft, corrective action.	Only show actions user can perform; backend revalidates every request.
Bulk actions	Export selected; send reminder where safe; archive drafts if policy allows.	Do not bulk-issue or bulk-cancel by default; confirmation and result report required.
Columns	Invoice number, customer, invoice date, due date, total, paid, balance, status, created by.	Allow optional column chooser; export respects selected filters, not just visible page.
Pagination	Page size 25 default; options 10/25/50/100.	Stable sorting to avoid duplicated/missing rows while paging.

Draft invoice may be edited/deleted subject to permissions. Once issued, invoice cannot be hard-deleted or silently edited. Corrections use a CA-approved cancellation/credit-note/corrective document flow.

7. Create Invoice screen — exact field specification

Recommended wizard: (1) Customer & invoice details → (2) Items and charges → (3) Tax and totals → (4) Notes and attachments → (5) Preview → (6) Save/approval/issue. An advanced user may use one-page layout, but validation must remain clear.

Field	Type / default	Rules
Customer	Searchable dropdown; Add Customer modal	Required; selecting customer fills legal name, GSTIN, addresses, state and default terms; allow one-time override only with audit note.
Document type	Tax invoice / bill of supply / other approved types	Show only types enabled by owner/CA; explain if user lacks permission.
Invoice series/number	Server-assigned; preview draft ID may be temporary	Never trust a number supplied by browser; unique DB constraint required.
Invoice date	Date picker, default today	Validate allowed date range against company policy and legal requirements.
Due date / terms	Customer default or company default	Editable by permission; warn if due date precedes invoice date.
Place of supply	State/UT dropdown and state code	Tax logic depends on reviewed supply rules; require manual confirmation where ambiguous.
Customer PO/reference	Optional text	Include on PDF if populated.
Service line	Catalogue search + custom line	Require description; preserve historical description in snapshot.
Qty / unit / rate	Decimal, dropdown, currency	No accidental negative quantities; allow only approved adjustment document logic.
Discount	Amount or percentage	Show discount and taxable base clearly; define line/invoice discount order.
Tax category/rate	Configured option	Default from item; override permission; require reason/audit for overrides.
Additional charges	Optional rows	Each charge must have approved tax treatment; do not assume all charges have same tax.
Round-off	Calculated or approved manual adjustment	Show clearly; prevent hidden balancing values.
Notes / terms	Customer note and standard terms	Separate customer-visible text from internal notes.
Attachments	Private files, optional	Explicitly choose which attachments are included in email; enforce size/type limits.
Save draft	Button	Saves work without marking issued; recover validation errors without losing entered data.
Preview	Button	Render using the same template engine as final PDF; label preview as draft if not issued.
Issue invoice	Button	Permission check, final validation, transactional number assignment, immutable snapshot, PDF archive, audit log.

8. GST and monetary calculation engine

Tax handling must be a separate, testable service—not scattered across form components. Configure tax types and rules only after the company's CA approves the actual scenarios for Legal Success India.

Rule	Required behaviour
Money precision	Use DECIMAL/NUMERIC in database and decimal arithmetic in backend. Never rely on binary floating-point for currency.
Line calculations	Store quantity, unit rate, discount, taxable value, tax type/rate, tax amount and line total as explicit values.
Intra/inter-state	Apply CGST+SGST/UTGST or IGST only according to the applicable transaction facts and approved rules; place of supply may require review.
Tax defaults	Service item can have a default reviewed tax configuration; users must see the rate/type before issue.
Exempt/zero-rated/reverse charge	Only enable options and required disclosures after CA confirms applicability and exact fields.
Rounding	Document rounding strategy: per line vs invoice total, decimal places and round-off handling; use same method in UI, PDF and reports.
Tax overrides	Restrict to authorised role; capture reason and audit record.
Historical values	Snapshot the applicable customer, supplier, service, tax rate and calculation at issue time; later settings changes do not alter old invoices.
Invoice fields	CA confirms required supplier/recipient details, GSTINs where applicable, invoice number/date, description, SAC/HSN where relevant, taxable value, tax, place of supply and other required declarations.
E-invoice	Phase 2 integration only if eligible/applicable; IRN and signed QR data must come from an authorised real workflow, never be fabricated.

Required test cases: intra-state supply; inter-state supply; customer without GSTIN where allowed; discount; multi-line mixed tax rates; rounding boundary; credit note; partial payment; customer state changed after invoice; service tax setting changed after invoice; invalid/missing GST profile. Expected values must be supplied/approved by the CA before coding.

9. PDF and print template system

PDF section	Required content / controls
Company header	Logo, Legal Success India branding, legal name if different, address, GSTIN/state code, email/phone/site as approved.
Document header	Document title, unique invoice number, issue date, due date, original/duplicate status only where appropriate.
Bill-to block	Customer legal name, billing address, GSTIN where applicable, state/state code, place of supply and customer reference.
Item table	Description, SAC/HSN where relevant, quantity/unit, rate, discount, taxable value, tax rate/type and tax amount; columns configurable.
Totals block	Taxable subtotal, discount, component-wise taxes, other charges, round-off and grand total; amount in words optional.
Footer	Payment terms, bank details/UPI instructions, customer note, terms, authorised signatory where appropriate, page number.
E-invoice data	Only actual IRN/acknowledgement/valid signed QR data if a real authorised integration produced it and it is required.
Print quality	A4 baseline; long descriptions wrap; multi-page repeated table header; totals on final page; no clipped columns.
Template editor	Logo upload, colour, footer, terms, bank block, column visibility, custom labels, font sizing and preview.
Snapshot/version	Store the issued PDF and relevant template/version reference; later template edits must not change old invoice archives.

PDF acceptance test: create a sample invoice with long company/customer names, 20+ line items, mixed tax categories, long descriptions, missing optional fields and a multi-page layout. Confirm PDF totals exactly match the saved invoice record.

10. Customer management module

Field / feature	Required behaviour
Customer type	Business or individual; do not require GSTIN for every customer if not applicable.
Identity	Legal name, display name, GST registration status, GSTIN, state/state code and contact person.
Addresses	Billing and shipping/service address separately; one marked default; support address history/snapshot on issued invoices.
Communication	Email, phone, optional WhatsApp contact; consent/communication preference field if automated messaging is later added.
Commercial terms	Default due days, standard note, assigned staff, tags and internal notes.
Customer detail	Tabs: overview, invoices, quotes, payments/credits, statement, attachments and activity.
Duplicate control	Warn for matching GSTIN, email or name; allow authorised merge process only with audit and no broken historical references.
Archive	Deactivate customer without deleting history; archived customer not selectable for new invoice unless restored/authorised.
Import/export	CSV template, column mapping, preview, invalid row report, duplicate strategy and export log.

11. Services/items catalogue for Legal Success India

The service catalogue should make repeat invoicing fast, but tax treatment must not be inferred from the service name. The owner/CA approves the description, pricing, SAC/HSN (where applicable), tax configuration and how any government fee is represented.

Field	Purpose / rule
Service name	Internal and invoice-facing names may differ; invoice-facing description must be clear to customer.
Service code	Optional internal ID, e.g. TM-PRO, CR-AID, FSSAI-AID; not a legal classification.
Description	Default scope text; staff can adjust for a particular customer before issue.
Rate / unit	Default fee, unit (service/package/hour/other), price precision and active flag.
Tax/SAC configuration	CA-approved tax category and SAC/HSN if applicable; no automatic tax assumption.
Fee classification	Internal tag: professional fee, government fee, third-party expense, reimbursement or other—tax/accounting presentation must be CA-approved.
Optional internal cost	Private-only cost field if management later wants margin reporting; never include on customer PDF.
Versioning	Historical invoice lines keep the description/rate/tax snapshot used when issued.

Seed catalogue candidates to review—not automatically activate: trademark filing assistance, copyright registration assistance, FSSAI licence assistance, document preparation, logo design, website design and business registration assistance. Verify actual service names, price list and tax treatment with the owner and CA.

12. Estimates / quotations — P1

Function	Detailed requirement
Create estimate	Customer, estimate number, issue/expiry date, service lines, discount, tax display where appropriate, scope, exclusions, terms and validity.
Statuses	Draft, sent, accepted, rejected, expired, converted, cancelled.
Send/preview	Branded PDF, email body, send log and manual resend.
Acceptance	Record acceptance date, method, actor and comments; e-signature/client portal is not MVP unless explicitly scoped.
Convert to invoice	Copy customer and line snapshots into a new invoice draft; user rechecks tax/date/terms; do not silently issue.
History	Retain old estimate versions or audit changes; conversion links estimate and invoice.

13. Payment records, balances and receipts

Feature	Behaviour / rules
Record payment	Invoice, payment date, amount, method, reference/UTR/transaction ID, received-by, internal note and attachment optional.
Methods	Cash, bank transfer, UPI, cheque, card/gateway and other admin-configured methods.
Partial payment	Allow multiple payment allocations against an invoice; outstanding = invoice total minus valid allocations/credits under approved policy.
Overpayment	Warn; do not silently over-allocate. Store as unapplied customer credit only if a designed workflow exists.
Payment correction	Use reversal/void with reason and permissions; preserve original event and audit trail.
Receipt	Optional unique receipt number, payment amount/date/method, invoice reference, customer and remaining balance.
Refund	Record refund as a separate event linked to payment/credit note; don't erase the original payment.
Gateway integration	Phase 2. Verify webhook signatures, make event processing idempotent and never store raw card details.
Reminder rules	Manual first; optional pre-due/on-due/after-due automation only after send logs, retries and suppression rules work.

Statuses should be derived consistently: Draft; Approval Pending; Issued/Sent; Partially Paid; Paid; Overdue as a derived flag; Cancelled/Void; Credited/Adjusted. “Email sent” must not be labelled “delivered” unless provider data supports that status.

14. Reports and export specifications

Report	Columns / definition	Priority
Invoice register	Invoice no/date, customer, taxable value, tax, total, paid, balance, status, creator.	P0
Outstanding invoices	Invoice, customer, due date, days overdue, total, paid, balance, reminder status.	P0
Receivables ageing	Current, 1–30, 31–60, 61–90, 90+ days from due date; document ageing basis.	P1
Collections	Payment date, invoice/customer, amount, method, reference and receiver.	P0
Tax summary	Taxable value/tax by rate and component; filters by period/customer/place of supply if captured.	P0
Customer statement	Transactions and opening/closing balance if opening balance support is implemented.	P1
Service-wise sales	Service, quantity, taxable amount, tax and invoice references.	P1
Credit/cancellation report	Original invoice, adjustment doc, reason, date, value and actor.	P0
Email activity	Invoice, recipient, send time, provider result, retries and failure reason.	P1
Export	CSV for spreadsheet, PDF print view; XLSX optional if budget supports.	P0

Every report must declare whether dates refer to invoice date, due date, issue date or payment date. Exports must obey role permissions, preserve filters, log who exported what and avoid exposing internal notes by default.

15. Settings & configuration

- **Company profile:** brand/logo, legal name, addresses, GSTIN, state code, contact channels, website and authorised signatory details.
- **Invoice series:** prefix, financial year, sequence width, next number, reset policy and draft numbering policy; lock issued numbers.
- **Financial year:** configurable start/end and report grouping; don't hardcode a year boundary.
- **Tax setup:** approved rates/categories, tax components, item defaults, effective dates, rounding and audit trail.
- **PDF templates:** logo, colours, footer, bank details, terms, columns, labels, page size and preview.
- **Payment terms:** due on receipt, 7/15/30 days or custom; defaults at company and customer level.
- **Email:** sender name/address, SMTP/provider setup, test message, retry rules and send log.
- **Users/roles:** invite, deactivate, role, permission review and last login.
- **Data tools:** CSV import, full export, invoice PDF archive, export log and import error reports.
- **Backup:** schedule, encryption, retention, off-site copy, alert when stale and tested restore procedure.
- **Audit:** append-oriented records for issued invoices, payments, corrections, company/tax settings, users, exports and template changes.

16. API contract outline

The developer should document API paths, request/response schemas, validation errors and permission requirements. These are illustrative endpoints, not a complete implementation contract. Choose REST or another consistent pattern; do not mix conventions randomly.

Module	Example endpoints	Notes
Auth	POST /auth/login; POST /auth/logout; POST /auth/password-reset	Rate-limit, secure sessions/tokens, no secrets in logs.
Company/settings	GET/PUT /company-profile; GET/PUT /settings/invoice-series; GET/PUT /settings/tax	Admin-only writes; audit every sensitive update.
Customers	GET/POST /customers; GET/PATCH /customers/{id}; POST /customers/import	Archive rather than hard-delete when history exists.
Services	GET/POST /items; GET/PATCH /items/{id}; POST /items/import	Snapshot item details on issue.
Invoices	GET/POST /invoices; GET/PATCH /invoices/{id}; POST /invoices/{id}/preview; POST /invoices/{id}/issue	Issue endpoint transactional and idempotent.
PDF/send	GET /invoices/{id}/pdf; POST /invoices/{id}/send	Authorise access; log file generation and email attempts.
Payments	GET/POST /payments; POST /payments/{id}/reverse; GET /invoices/{id}/payments	Balance recalculated server-side.
Credits	POST /credit-notes; POST /credit-notes/{id}/issue	CA-approved workflow and original invoice link.
Reports	GET /reports/invoice-register; GET /reports/collections; GET /reports/tax-summary	Server-side filtering and role-scoped export.
Audit	GET /audit-logs	Restricted access; append-only approach.

API safety: validate all IDs and ownership, apply server-side permission checks, use database transactions, support idempotency for issue/send/payment callbacks, return stable error codes, and avoid exposing stack traces or internal paths.

17. Database schema and integrity rules

Table/entity	Minimum data / constraints
users	id, name, email unique, password_hash, status, role relation, last_login, created_at.
roles/permissions	role, permission, user-role mapping, role-permission mapping.
company_profiles	legal/trade name, GSTIN, address, state code, logo storage key, contact data.
customers	type, legal/display name, GSTIN, addresses, state, contacts, terms, active flag.
items_services	name, description, code, unit, rate, tax config, SAC/HSN if relevant, active flag.
invoices	series, number, status, issue/due dates, customer reference, monetary totals, creator, issued_at, version.
invoice_lines	invoice_id, description snapshot, qty, rate, discount, taxable value, tax type/rate/amount, line total.
payments	receipt number, date, amount, method, reference, status, receiver, reversal link.
payment_allocations	payment_id, invoice_id, amount; checks prevent allocations beyond approved rules.
credit_notes	number, date, original invoice, reason, tax/total values, status and issued snapshot.
estimates	number, customer, dates, status, lines/snapshot and conversion invoice ID.
attachments/files	storage key, MIME type, size, checksum, owner entity and access metadata.
email_logs	entity, recipient, channel, template version, provider ID, attempt, result, error summary.
audit_logs	actor, action, entity, timestamp, request ID, before/after summary; append-only controls.

- Unique constraint: company/profile + series + issued invoice number.
- Foreign keys prevent orphaned invoice lines, payments and credits.
- Use DECIMAL/NUMERIC for money; timestamps stored consistently and displayed in the company’s chosen timezone.
- Issued snapshots are immutable; new correction documents reference the original instead of rewriting history.
- Database migrations and seed data are version-controlled; no manual production schema edits without migration.

18. Security, privacy, audit and backup

- **Authentication:** secure password hashing, login rate limits, reset tokens expire and are single-use, secure session cookies, logout invalidates session.
- **Authorisation:** server/API RBAC on every endpoint; customer-level scoping where needed; test direct URL and API bypass attempts.
- **Web security:** HTTPS, CSRF protection where applicable, XSS/input validation, parameterised queries, secure file upload rules and dependency updates.
- **File privacy:** invoice PDFs/attachments private by default; signed expiring links if sharing externally; never use guessable public file paths.
- **Secrets:** SMTP/API keys in environment secrets or secret manager; never commit them to Git; rotate on staff/developer exit.
- **Audit trail:** record sensitive actions, actor, timestamp, entity and reason; don't log passwords, tokens or unnecessary personal data.
- **Backups:** daily baseline, encrypted/off-site copy, retention policy and a successful restore test before launch.
- **Operational alerts:** failed email jobs, disk/storage usage, application errors, stale backups and unusual login activity.
- **Offboarding:** disable account, revoke sessions and keys, transfer ownership of records and preserve audit history.

Operational target	Suggested starting point
Backup/RPO	At most 24 hours of data loss with daily backups; improve frequency if risk or volume requires.
Recovery/RTO	Document a realistic recovery target, e.g. same business day, and test it.
Availability	Depends on selected hosting and monitoring; don't promise enterprise SLA on low-cost VPS.
Data export	Owner can export customers, services, invoices, payment allocations and audit-relevant data.

19. Prioritised feature backlog with acceptance criteria

ID	Feature	Priority	Acceptance criteria
P0-01	Login & roles	P0	Protected API denies unauthorised access; each staff member has own account.
P0-02	Company/GST settings	P0	Approved profile appears correctly in PDF; changes are audited.
P0-03	Customers	P0	Create/edit/archive/search/import; duplicate warning and import error file work.
P0-04	Service catalogue	P0	Saved defaults populate draft; tax details remain visible/reviewable.
P0-05	Invoice editor	P0	Line math, discounts, tax and totals match test matrix.
P0-06	GST calculation tests	P0	CA-approved cases pass; ambiguous scenarios cannot be silently guessed.
P0-07	Numbering	P0	Concurrent issue attempts never duplicate a number; failed transaction doesn't corrupt sequence.
P0-08	Issue & snapshot	P0	Issued invoice is immutable; later customer/item/template edits do not alter it.
P0-09	PDF/preview	P0	Preview, download and sent attachment have same totals and key fields.
P0-10	Invoice register	P0	Search, filters, sorting, pagination and export are correct.
P0-11	Payments	P0	Partial/full payment updates balance; duplicate/reversed payment handled safely.
P0-12	Reports	P0	Invoice register, outstanding and collections reconcile with record detail.
P0-13	Email/send log	P0	Failures visible/retryable; retry does not create duplicate invoice.
P0-14	Audit trail	P0	Issue, payment, correction, settings and export actions logged.
P0-15	Backup/restore	P0	Owner can export core data; documented restore succeeds in test environment.
P0-16	Correction workflow	P0 safety	No hard delete or silent edit after issue; CA-approved corrective path works.
P1-01	Estimates/quotes	P1	Accepted quote converts to a new invoice draft with line data preserved.
P1-02	Receipt PDF	P1	Receipt links to payment/invoice and displays correct amount/date/method.
P1-03	Reminder automation	P1	No reminders after paid/void; schedule and send result logged.
P1-04	Basic expenses	P1	Categorised expense export works; no claim of full accounting.
P2-01	Recurring invoices	P2	Schedule changes and retries cannot create duplicate invoices.
P2-02	Customer portal	P2	Customer sees only their own records; password/reset/privacy tested.
P2-03	WhatsApp Business API	P2	Provider setup, approved templates, consent and failures are handled.
P2-04	E-invoice/GSTN API	P2	Eligibility/credentials confirmed; genuine IRN/QR and cancellation flow tested.
P2-05	Payment gateway	P2	Webhook signatures verified; duplicate callbacks idempotent; refunds traceable.

20. Edge-case and failure-mode catalogue

Scenario	Expected behaviour
Two staff issue invoices simultaneously	Database transaction and unique constraint prevent duplicate numbers; losing request gets a clear retry message.
User double-clicks Issue	Idempotency prevents duplicate invoice; UI disables button during request but backend remains authoritative.
Email provider down	Invoice stays issued; send status shows failed; retry can resend same archived PDF without issuing again.
Customer address changed later	Old issued invoice shows old snapshot; new invoices use current profile.
Service price/tax changed	Old issued invoice unchanged; new draft uses current defaults.
Partial payment then refund/reversal	Allocation and balance update through traceable reversal; no deleted history.
Payment exceeds balance	Warn and block or place in unapplied credit workflow; no silent negative balance.
Draft saved but browser closes	Saved draft is recoverable; unsaved warning if practical.
CSV contains bad rows	Import preview shows row number, error and reason; valid rows are not silently mis-mapped.
PDF attachment too large	Show size limit and actionable error; don't mark email as sent.
Staff permission revoked mid-session	API denies subsequent restricted action; sensitive sessions/tokens invalidated as appropriate.
Backup job fails	Alert admin; last successful backup timestamp visible; don't claim backup succeeded.
Credit note against wrong invoice	Require original invoice selection and validation; retain links and audit history.
Financial year changes	Configured numbering/report rules apply; existing numbers remain unchanged.

21. QA, UAT and release checklist

Test group	Required test examples
Calculation	Tax per line; multiple rates; discount; round-off; large amounts; decimal quantities if allowed; credit note.
Number sequence	Concurrent requests; retry; rollback; year boundary; series configuration; no number reuse if policy forbids.
Permissions	Every role tested against UI and API; direct URL access; export restrictions; staff offboarding.
PDF	One line, 25 lines, long names, long descriptions, multi-page, logo absent, special characters, print margins.
Payment	Full, partial, multiple partials, reversal, overpayment, credit allocation and reminder suppression.
Data integrity	Customer/item edits after issue; template edits; archived customer; duplicate import; historical PDF retrieval.
Email	Valid/invalid address, provider failure, retry, duplicate click, attachment mismatch and audit log.
Recovery	Restore database and private files to clean environment; confirm login, invoice detail and PDFs.
Browser/mobile	Current Chrome/Edge; responsive screen; keyboard navigation; errors readable on small screens.
UAT sign-off	Owner, billing staff and CA/reviewer approve sample invoices, reports and correction workflow.

22. Delivery plan, milestones and developer handover

Milestone	Work	Exit gate
M0 — Discovery	Confirm company legal name/GSTIN/state, sample invoices, service catalogue, invoice numbering, tax cases, roles and correction policy.	Signed-off inputs; no guessed tax configuration.
M1 — Foundation	Repository, environments, auth/RBAC, database migrations, audit framework, company settings, backup setup.	Security baseline and schema review.
M2 — Invoice core	Customers, services, invoice editor, calculation service, sequence, snapshots, PDF preview/download.	End-to-end sample invoice matches approved output.
M3 — Payments	Manual/partial payments, balances, receipts, invoice status and reminder groundwork.	Balances reconcile; reversal cases pass.
M4 — Reports & communication	Invoice register, outstanding/collections/tax summary, email/send log, exports.	Reports reconcile; send failure/retry works.
M5 — UAT & launch	CA review, staff UAT, security checks, restore test, production deployment, operating guide.	Written launch approval.
M6 — Phase 2	Quotes, expense register, automated reminders, portal, gateway, WhatsApp API, e-invoice integration if needed.	Separate scope, price and acceptance tests.

Planning range: a focused MVP may take roughly 4–8 weeks for an experienced developer/team if scope remains controlled; more integrations, complex approvals or bespoke design can extend this. Treat this as a planning estimate, not a vendor quote.

Developer must hand over

- Company-owned source repository, complete source code and dependency/licence list.
- Database schema, migrations, seed data, API documentation and environment variable list without secrets.
- Deployment scripts, domain/hosting ownership, SSL setup and administrator access.
- PDF templates and source assets; sample PDFs; test suite and QA report.
- Backup schedule, restore guide, security notes, known limitations and support/warranty terms.
- Admin training and a short user guide for invoice creation, payments, corrections and exports.

23. Cost planning and avoiding recurring SaaS fees

Cost item	Planning notes	Control
Development	Largest cost; varies with existing code, rates, quality and tax testing.	Request 2–3 milestone-based quotes against this document.
Domain	Often a modest annual cost; extension/registrar vary.	Company account owns the domain.
Hosting/server	Small deployment may start at a low monthly cost; backup/database/traffic can increase it.	Choose based on security, backup and support—not only lowest price.
Email	Provider free tier may be sufficient at first; delivery reputation and volume matter.	Use company domain; configure SPF/DKIM/DMARC as applicable.
Backup storage	Depends on PDF/file volume and retention.	Off-site encrypted copy; test restore.
WhatsApp API	Optional provider and message/template charges may apply.	Start with manual share; automate only if worthwhile.
Gateway	Optional transaction charges and integration effort.	Do not add until clients need online payment.
GSTN/IRP/GSP	Separate eligibility, credentials, API and provider requirements.	CA and provider confirm applicability and current cost.
Maintenance	Security updates, bug fixes, hosting changes and support continue after launch.	Agree response times and ownership in writing.

24. Legal Success India-specific setup checklist

Input	Owner/CA to confirm	Why needed
Brand and legal entity	Legal Success India brand; exact legal name/constitution to verify.	Brand can differ from registered legal name.
GST profile	GSTIN, registration state, registered address and applicable tax settings.	Invoice header and GST behaviour.
Invoice series	Prefix, financial-year policy, sequence width and opening number.	Unique and auditable numbering.
Logo/brand	Approved high-resolution logo, brand colours and signature if authorised.	Professional invoice template.
Bank/payment details	Approved bank account/UPI/payment instructions.	Optional invoice footer and receipts.
Service list	Approved service names, rates, descriptions, SAC/HSN where relevant and tax treatment.	Prevent wrong tax defaults.
Fee breakdown	Professional fee vs government fee vs third-party charges/reimbursements and how each should be displayed.	Must reflect real transaction and CA-approved accounting/tax treatment.
Invoice examples	2–3 anonymised current invoices, including any credit/correction example.	Validate required fields and expected visual output.
Roles	Names/emails and role permissions for billing, sales, owner and accountant.	Secure team access.
Email domain	Company-controlled sender address and provider.	Invoice delivery and trust.
Retention/export	CA-approved record retention and export requirements.	Compliance and handover.

25. Example acceptance scenarios

Scenario	Given / action	Expected result
Create a standard invoice	Valid customer, approved service, tax configuration; staff fills invoice and issues it.	Unique number assigned once; PDF matches saved totals; audit record exists.
Wrong tax setting attempt	Staff without tax override permission changes tax rate.	Server rejects request; UI explains permission; attempted change is logged where appropriate.
Partial payment	Invoice ■10,000; record ■4,000 valid payment.	Paid ■4,000; balance ■6,000; status Partially Paid; payment receipt available if enabled.
Invoice fully paid	Add valid payment for remaining balance.	Balance ■0; status Paid; future reminders stop.
Edit customer after invoice	Change customer address then reopen old issued invoice.	Old invoice retains original snapshot; new draft uses current address.
Email fails	Email provider rejects message.	Invoice remains issued; status shows send failed; retry does not create a second invoice.
Export monthly register	Owner selects date range and exports.	Export includes all filtered rows, not just current page; filter/date basis and export event recorded.
Correct an issued invoice	User selects correction workflow.	Original remains; linked approved corrective document is created; no hard delete.
Restore backup	Admin restores backup to staging.	Users, invoices, payments and archived PDFs are available and reconcile.

26. Go-live checklist and sign-off

- Company legal identity, GSTIN, registered address and invoice series have been verified by owner/CA.
- CA has approved tax test cases, document types, mandatory fields, SAC/HSN treatment where relevant, and cancellation/credit-note workflow.
- All P0 features pass acceptance tests and UAT; sample invoices are approved in writing.
- Issued invoice snapshots and archived PDFs cannot be silently rewritten.
- Role/permission tests and file privacy checks pass.
- Email send/retry, exports and data import have been tested.
- Backup/restore has been tested; production secrets are secured; HTTPS and monitoring are active.
- Domain, hosting, repository, database and provider accounts are controlled by the company.
- Developer has supplied source code, runbook, user guide, dependency list, and known-issues list.
- Staff know how to issue an invoice, record payment, download PDF, export records and request corrections.

Do not issue live tax invoices until the owner and CA approve the company profile, tax behaviour, numbering and final PDF. A visually professional PDF alone does not guarantee legal GST compliance.

27. Reference sources and assumptions

This blueprint maps publicly described product capabilities and applies product-engineering best practices. It does not claim to have reverse-engineered private implementation or audited every interaction in the live demo. Features and statutory rules can change; verify them before launch.

Source	Link	Use
Zoho Invoice India — product overview	https://www.zoho.com/in/invoice/	Public overview of GST invoicing, quotes, reminders, expenses, portal, reports and exports.
Zoho Invoice — features	https://www.zoho.com/in/invoice/features/	Public feature catalogue for invoices, contacts, payments, templates, automation, roles and items.
Zoho Invoice — simple invoicing software	https://www.zoho.com/in/invoice/simple-invoice-software/	Public information on dashboard, modules, roles, client portal and mobile access.
Zoho Invoice — templates	https://www.zoho.com/in/invoice/templates/	Public template and branding features.
GST Portal	https://www.gst.gov.in/	Official source for current GST portal instructions and resources.
E-Invoice Portal	https://einvoice.gst.gov.in/	Official source for current e-invoice eligibility, process and instructions.

Important limitation: the live demo is interactive and may change. A feature-by-feature pixel audit requires direct inspection of each demo screen and its current behaviour. This document is a detailed, implementation-oriented MVP proposal based on public product information and the company needs described so far.

NEXT STEP

Approve the scope, then create screen-by-screen wireframes and developer tickets for P0-01 through P0-16. Before tax logic is implemented, gather the company's verified GST profile and CA-approved sample invoice(s).